

Your background with the candidate

How do you know this person? Where did you work with this person?

Michal was an intern in my research lab at Snap last summer, and he did a terrific job on two different engineering-oriented projects — far exceeding the goals that we set out for him at the beginning of the internship. While I was not his direct mentor, I interacted with him on a regular basis throughout the summer, and I attended his presentations at both the internship's beginning and end.

General cognitive ability

How smart is this person? What caused you to believe that?

Michal has the ability to rapidly come up to speed on both existing research and an existing codebase, to implement research within that codebase, and to extend that research. He is also able to optimize code so that it runs efficiently in a mobile environment. In addition, Michal's Master's thesis won the prestigious Dean's Award at his university, Czech Tech.

Role-related knowledge and experience

Why would this candidate be well-prepared for this job? For engineering roles, please discuss coding ability and specific technical areas of expertise along with other knowledge and experience.

Michal is a unique candidate in that he is a student of Daniel Sykora's, who I expect to become a 20%-time Google Visiting Researcher, also based in PRG. Michal is currently in between his Master's degree and starting his PhD, which he plans to begin as soon as the internship ends. He has extensive experience in 3D computer graphics and image stylization in particular, which will be extremely relevant to the "style transfer in 3D" project we have in mind for him.

Leadership

How has this candidate demonstrated their ability to make a team more successful, above and beyond their personal contributions?

I am not aware of leadership work that Michal has done per se, although he worked as part of a team on his last internship at Snap Research, and he certainly worked well with the team and helped everyone on it become more successful through his strong personal work ethic and interpersonal skills.

Googlyness

Why is Google the right company for this candidate, and this candidate right for Google?

Michal has a soft-spoken, self-effacing personality. He is a great communicator — and speaks four languages. He works extremely well as part of a team, making everyone around him more successful. From a cultural perspective he will fit in very well.